

Furman University Music Composition Society Constitution

Article I. Furman University Music Composition Society

The formal name of this organization shall be the Furman University Music Composition Society.

Article II. Purpose

The purpose of the Music Composition Society is to create a space and community centered around music composition that can include composition majors, other music-majors who take composition lessons or classes, or non-majors who are simply interested in the art of composition. The organization will meet to discuss ongoing composers' pieces in both composition lessons and seminars, broad discussions of composition processes, and ways to support each other in our musical ventures. Other goals include connecting Furman composers both locally with Furman alumni composers, or non-alumni composers in the area, as well as contacting composers abroad who may already be visiting Furman or would be willing to travel. Finally, the organization will promote outreach that engages and inspires the local area in the art of composition.

Article III. Affiliation

The Music Composition Society is affiliated with the Furman University Music Department. The organization will work closely with the professor of composition. This organization is a recognized organization at Furman University and adheres to all University policies as set forth in the Furman University Student Handbook.

Article IV. Membership

While our goals and conversations will be rooted in music composition, the organization will be open to any Furman students who wish to join the conversation, regardless of their number of studies in composition or music. In keeping with Furman University's non-discrimination policies, membership shall be open to all undergraduate, day students. Our organization will not discriminate on the basis of race, sex, handicap, age, sexual orientation, political affiliation, or religious affiliation.

Article V. Officers

Section 1: Terms

Officers shall be elected within the last six weeks of the academic school year, and terms will be based on academic years rather than calendar years. Officers may serve the full academic year or one semester, depending on their position (see Article VI). Officers may be reelected the following year.

Section 2: Eligibility

To serve as an officer, one must have demonstrated at least a year's worth of composition study (which shall be defined as taking either composition lessons for credit and/or composition seminar), be enrolled at the time of candidacy, and continue to enroll during their term. A first-year student may run for office if they are in the process of completing their second semester of composition study.

Article VI. Duties of Officers

Officers shall consist of a President, Vice President, Treasurer, Secretary, and Historian.

- The **President** will organize and lead meetings, oversee activities outside of meetings, be the first point of contact for any conflicts that arise in the organization (unless the nature of conflict involves the president, or necessitates faculty advisor, dean, or police involvement) and serve as the primary representative of the organization.
- The **Vice President** will assist the President when needed, help coordinate events, and step in when the President is unavailable.
- The **Secretary** will keep a record of attendance during meetings and events when applicable. They will take minutes to keep a record of important information discussed during meetings.
- The **Treasurer** will manage and track the organization's budget and finances, create an annual budget request application for SGA, and ensure financial transparency.
 - Must serve a full academic year.
- The **Historian** will document activities outside of meetings, create advertisements for events, and maintain communications with alumni composers.

If manageable, the Vice President, Secretary, and Historian may hold two officer roles from those positions. The President and Treasurer may not hold multiple positions. The creation and maintenance of a social media presence may be held or shared by any officer(s).

With the exception of treasurer, officers may run for semester-terms; a fall-semester candidate may run alongside a spring-semester candidate. If the candidate elects not to run alongside a replacement, then an election will be held on the last scheduled meeting of the fall semester to fill expected vacancies. The presidency may be divided into a co-presidency if one president will be physically absent for a semester.

Article VII. Finances

The treasurer will complete an annual budget request application from SGA, which may include funding for bringing in guest composers, sheet music, workshops, and/or conferences.

Article VIII. Amendments to the Constitution

An amendment to the constitution must be petitioned to the President with the support of at least one third (1/3) of the total membership to be formally presented. The proposed amendment will then be discussed and voted on at the next scheduled meeting. To be adopted, the amendment must receive approval from at least two-thirds (2/3) of the voting members present.

Bylaws

Article I. Meetings & Events

Meetings shall be scheduled at least four times a semester. Events may include masterclasses, composition recitals, outreach events, and any other events sponsored by the Music Composition Society.

Article II. Membership

Section 1: Membership Interest

Interested members must fill out an interest form to determine category, basic information, and information about compositional interests and potential contributions to the Society. Interested members may attend any meeting.

Section 2: Definition of Members in Good Standing

Members shall be defined as in good standing if they meet the following requirements:

- Attend at least two meetings a semester
- Attend at least one event a year

Members who do not meet the requirements for being in good standing may remain a part of the Music Composition Society but are ineligible to both run and vote in elections.

Article III. Officer Vacancies and Removals - Special Election

Section 1: Vacancy

In the event of a vacancy of the vice president, secretary, treasurer, or historian, the executive committee will convene to first discuss if it is manageable for an officer to absorb the vacant position. If not possible, for the positions of secretary or historian, they will nominate a member until one accepts. Since the vice president could assume the president's role in an absence, a special election will take place for the vice president, which shall be done no later than one week from the occurrence of the vacancy, and may be done online instead of in-person. Finally, if the presidency becomes vacant, the vice president will assume the role, and a special election

will either be held for the president or vice president position, depending on the interim-president's willingness to continue their presidency, and will follow the same special election guidelines as the vice presidency vacancy.

Section 2: Removal

An officer may be considered for removal due to negligence of duties, misconduct, or actions that undermine the goals of the organization. Petitions for removal can be raised by the members of the executive committee, in which the committee must give the officer a warning and four weeks to determine improvement. Petitions can also be raised by at least one-third ($\frac{1}{3}$) of the general membership, outlining the reasons for removal. The petition will be presented to the officer to respond, and four weeks will be given to improve before a recall may be held. Proven allegations of mishandling funds, abuse of power, or discrimination will not constitute a warning but immediate removal.

Article IV. Faculty Advisor

Section 1: Advisor Appointment

An advisor will be selected from the music department, ideally from the theory and composition department. The advisor will be picked by the executive committee and presented to the membership. If a concern is raised by the membership, a vote may be held for the advisor, in which a simple majority may overturn the executive committee. Following an overturn, a new advisor must be voted on by the membership.

Section 2: Advisor Removal

Petition for the removal of an advisor must be presented and supported by one-third ($\frac{1}{3}$) of the membership or a complete majority of the executive committee. Upon petition, a vote will be held at the next scheduled meeting, in which a two-thirds ($\frac{2}{3}$) majority will be required to remove an advisor.

Article V. Rules of Order

Meetings will follow this agenda:

- Introduction from President while the Secretary takes attendance
- Old Business, from Officers first, then the general membership
- New Business, from Officers first, then the general membership
- Discussion of members' compositions or other topics related to composition at Furman or compositional processes
- Announcements and Adjournment

Organizations may not address a member's violations of university policy via internal standards boards or other accountability mechanisms without prior approval of the Dean of Students Office. Conduct expectations unique to membership in the organization and that do not overlap or otherwise interfere with university authority may be addressed with the written approval of the AVP/Dean of Students or designee. Groups affiliated with national organizations that have established guidance and procedures over disciplinary matters, may follow the directive of those national organizations with regard to member conduct but must do so with written approval of the university.

Article VI. Committees

An executive committee will be established, made up of all officers. The executive committee will briefly discuss the agenda of meetings beforehand, either in person or virtually. They will also convene for special votes as needed. The faculty advisor and/or professor of composition may join the executive committee during meetings, but will not be granted a vote.

Article VII. Amendment to Bylaws

Bylaws will undergo revision within the last six weeks of each fall semester, with the executive committee locating potential revisions while also offering the opportunity for non-officers to do so as well. Potential revisions must receive a majority vote of present voters to pass.